Aadabidda Nidhi Scheme

1. Scheme Overview and Policy Objectives

The Aadabidda Nidhi Scheme is a landmark social welfare flagship launched under the 'Super Six' welfare framework by the Government of Andhra Pradesh. Conceived to address economic distress and enhance financial autonomy among adult women, the scheme provides unencumbered monthly income directly to eligible female family members. The financial benefit is Rs. 1,500 per month, which totals Rs. 18,000 annually per beneficiary. The target group includes resident women aged 18 to 59 years from economically weaker sections. Disbursements are made via Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) into Aadhaar-seeded bank accounts. Currently, the scheme has an approved policy blueprint, with implementation rules and portal rollout underway.

The primary policy objectives include promoting financial independence by furnishing independent personal liquidity to women to enhance self-reliance and household decision-making leverage. It aims to alleviate poverty and buffer households by assisting disadvantaged families in meeting baseline expenditures on nutrition, healthcare, and education. Furthermore, it curbs usurious debt by mitigating dependence on predatory private micro-lenders and promotes economic inclusion by integrating underprivileged women fully into formal banking and financial services via Aadhaar-enabled payments.

2. Financial and Welfare Benefits

Beneficiaries receive a monthly cash grant of Rs. 1,500 credited directly to the woman's savings bank account, leading to a cumulative annual entitlement of Rs. 18,000 per financial year per approved applicant. The disbursement mechanism utilizes electronic Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) through the Aadhaar Payment Bridge System (APBS), which entirely eliminates physical middlemen. This financial support is unconditional in nature; funds can be used flexibly for health, child schooling, family nutrition, or petty entrepreneurship at the beneficiary's absolute discretion.

3. Eligibility and Exclusion Criteria

Applicants must satisfy specific demographic, economic, and residency standards to qualify for the scheme. Firstly, the applicant must be a permanent resident of Andhra Pradesh, with domicile verified through official database records. The scheme is exclusively applicable to female citizens aged between 18 and 59 years (inclusive); beneficiaries crossing 60 years will transition to old-age social security pensions under NTR Bharosa. Eligible socio-economic categories include Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST), Backward Classes (BC), Minorities, or Economically Weaker Sections (EWS). Applicants must possess a valid Below Poverty Line (BPL) White Ration Card or Rice Card registered in Andhra Pradesh. Finally, the annual household income must remain within government-notified poverty thresholds, typically under Rs. 1,20,000 for rural areas and Rs. 1,44,000 for urban areas.

Standard exclusion norms apply. Parallel pension recipients already receiving monthly social security pensions under NTR Bharosa (e.g., widow, disability, single woman pensions) are excluded to avoid benefit duplication. Families where any member is a regular government employee or retired government pensioner, as well as families with members actively filing or liable to pay income tax, are ineligible. Households possessing four-wheelers (excluding commercial tractors or taxis operated for livelihood) or those exceeding permissible agricultural land thresholds (standard limit: max 3 acres wetland or 10 acres dry land) are also excluded.

4. Documentation Checklist

Prospective applicants are required to maintain original documents and photocopies. An Aadhaar Card issued by UIDAI is needed for individual identity, biometric verification, and bank DBT seeding. A White Ration Card or Rice Card from the Civil Supplies Department validates household family membership and BPL economic status. An active single bank passbook in the applicant's name with an IFSC code from a Commercial or Gramin Bank is required for fund transfers. An Income Certificate from the Revenue Department (MeeSeva/Tahsildar) validates annual household earnings, while a Caste Certificate proves community status if applicable. Proof of age, such as an SSC Marks Memo or Birth Certificate, along with recent passport photographs and an Aadhaar-linked active mobile number, complete the necessary documentation.

5. Step-by-Step Application & Verification Lifecycle

The operational procedure for enrollment integrates both local frontline physical desks and digital portals. In Step 1, applicants must prepare their documents and ensure their bank account is fully active with NPCI Aadhaar seeding completed. Step 2 involves application submission, where eligible women apply either online through the dedicated AP welfare portal or offline through Grama/Ward Sachivalayams and MeeSeva kiosks.

Step 3 features field scrutiny and social audits, where Village Welfare Assistants and Ward Welfare Secretaries conduct field checks to verify income, residential status, and family card records. In Step 4, preliminary beneficiary lists are published at local secretariats for objections and social vetting. Step 5 involves approval and sanction, where Mandal Parishad Development Officers (MPDO) or Municipal Commissioners validate the list and forward it for final state sanction. Finally, in Step 6, the monthly payments of Rs. 1,500 are disbursed directly to beneficiary accounts on specified payment dates.

An official advisory cautions beneficiaries against fraudulent agents, unofficial mobile applications, or unauthorized fee demands. Application forms and verification via Grama/Ward Secretariats are provided free of cost. Applicants must ensure their Aadhaar is mapped to their active bank account via the NPCI portal or nearest bank branch to prevent DBT remittance failures.